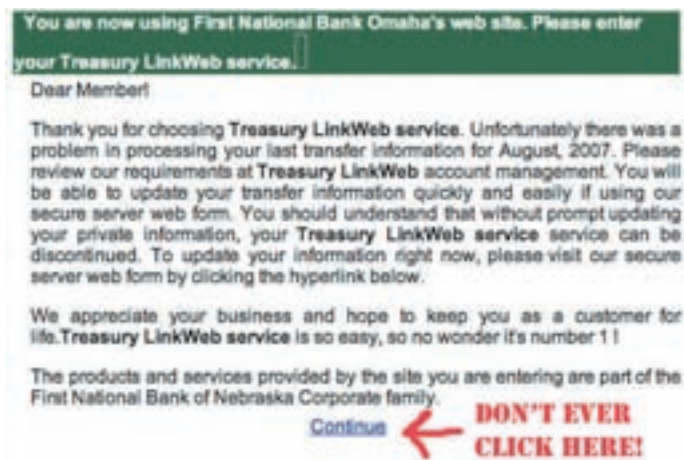




Think twice before clicking on inviting links

won millions in some random foreign lottery (with the key to receiving these millions being to pay some money up front), you'll know what we mean. The perpetrators behind these messages want nothing more than for you to mail them your credit card/bank account numbers.

The best way to spot hoaxes is a good dose of common sense. As the saying goes, "If it sounds too good to be true, it usually is". The Internet Crime Complaint Center, Federal Trade Commission and Better Business Bureau all recommend the following tips for protecting your personal info.

- Do not respond to the scam email, click on links, or open attachments, which could leave your computer at risk for viruses.
- If the email appears to have come from a company, check their web site to see if they've addressed any scams using their name, and contact the Better Business Bureau to find out if there have been any complaints about such a scam.

In case you've responded to what you believe was a scam, then make sure to contact your bank immediately and ask what steps you should take to protect your money. You should also review your free credit report to monitor your active accounts, mortgages, and other financial information. Always treat email